

Lesson 2

我有兩個弟弟 — I Have Two Younger Brothers

Let's Learn Mandarin · Book 1 · Teacher's Manual

壹. Learning Objectives

Theme: Family

After completing this lesson, students will be able to use Chinese to:

1. Describe family members and how many there are.
 2. Ask others whether they have siblings.
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貳. Key Teaching Points and Activity Design

I. Warm-Up Activity

1. Activity method:

- 1. The teacher asks questions and has students introduce their own or classmates' names and nationalities.
- 2. Use pictures to introduce kinship terms. Kinship terms not in this lesson's vocabulary list do not need to be emphasized — terms like “爸爸 (dad)” and “媽媽 (mom)” can simply be mentioned in passing.

2. Sentences to use:

- 他是_____ (kinship term) 。 / 他姓_____。 / 他是_____人。
 - (He is _____ [relation]. / His surname is _____. / He is from _____.)
-

II. Vocabulary Instruction

1. “兩” (liǎng) expresses quantity and must be followed by a measure word. This lesson teaches “兩個” first in order to let students naturally get used to the “兩 + measure word” pattern. Teachers do not need to explain the difference between “二” and “兩” here — the distinction will be explained in Lesson 7 when numbers are taught.
2. “你 / 妳” are second-person pronouns referring to males and females respectively, though “你” can also be used to refer to females. They are pronounced the same but written differently. During instruction, pictures may be used with sentences to help students understand the difference between “你” and “妳.”
3. “一” has three pronunciations listed in the vocabulary table. Please explain the tone-change rules for “一” in class.
4. The kinship terms “哥哥 (older brother), 姐姐 (older sister), 弟弟 (younger brother), 妹妹 (younger sister)” all have their second character read in the neutral tone; this is also marked in the

vocabulary table.

5. “姊姊” is listed in the vocabulary table alongside “姊姊 / 姐姐.” Although the character “姐” is interchangeable with “姊,” is easier to write, and appears frequently (e.g., in “小姐”), the textbook consistently uses the standard form “姊姊” in the lesson text. “姐姐” will appear naturally in other grammar examples for students to recognize. Teachers may choose which form to use based on the situation.

◎ Teaching Method

For zero-level vocabulary instruction, it is recommended to teach **from top to bottom, using sentences as the foundation** — not in isolation from the text. During instruction, context should be paired with the text and grammar simultaneously, so students learn to recognize vocabulary, become familiar with usage, and consolidate pronunciation. See the Suggested Teaching Flow under Text Instruction for step-by-step details. The kinship terms in this lesson — “哥哥, 姐姐, 弟弟, 妹妹” — are nouns that belong to the same word group with clear concepts, and can be introduced separately during the warm-up activity.

III. Grammar Instruction

1. 有 / 沒有 (Have / Don't Have)

“有” is a verb. To make it negative, add “沒” before it to form “沒有.” Chinese has two main negative adverbs; “沒” is one of them.

- S + 沒 (Negative Adverb) + 有 (V) + O (N)
- 我 沒有 妹妹。 (*I don't have a younger sister.*)
- Gloria 沒有 哥哥。 (*Gloria doesn't have an older brother.*)

When the sentence contains other adverbs, such as “也” (also) or “只” (only), they are placed before “有 / 沒有.”

- S + Adverb + 沒有 / 有 (V) + O (N)
 - Gloria 也 沒有 弟弟。 (*Gloria also doesn't have a younger brother.*)
 - Gloria 只 有 一個姐姐。 (*Gloria only has one older sister.*)
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2. 嗎 (Question Particle)

“嗎” is an interrogative particle. When added to the end of a complete declarative sentence, it turns the sentence into a yes/no question.

- Sentence + 嗎 ?
 - 您姓王 嗎 ? (*Is your surname Wang?*)
 - S + V + O + 嗎 ?
 - 你 是 美國人 嗎 ? (*Are you American?*)
 - 你 叫 明文 嗎 ? (*Is your name Mingwen?*)
-

3. 個 (Measure Word)

“個” is the most frequently used measure word in Chinese. When expressing quantity in Chinese, a measure word must always be placed between the number and the noun.

- Numeral + Measure Word + N

- 一個妹妹 (*one younger sister*)

It should be emphasized that “兩” must always be followed by a measure word. There are a small number of exceptions where no measure word is needed, but these are not covered in this lesson. If students ask about the difference between “兩” and “二,” simply provide more real examples and practice to reinforce the “兩 + measure word” concept, rather than explaining it abstractly — it will be addressed in Lesson 7.

◎ **Common student error:** Omitting the measure word — e.g., 我有一弟弟。 (*incorrect: “I have one younger brother.”*)

4. 也 (Also)

“也” is an adverb indicating that what is being said is the same as something previously mentioned. In Chinese, adverbs must always be placed after the subject and before the verb.

- S + Adverb + V + O
- 我也是臺灣人。 (*I am also Taiwanese.*)

◎ **Common student errors:** 1. Placing “也” at the beginning of the sentence — e.g., 也我 (是) 臺灣人。 (*incorrect*) 2. Missing the verb — e.g., 我也臺灣人。 (*incorrect*) 3. Omitting the elements after “也” — e.g., 我也。 (*incorrect: “Me too.”*)

IV. Text Instruction

◆ Key Sentences

1. 你有兄弟姐妹嗎? (*Do you have siblings?*)
2. 我有一個姊姊，兩個弟弟。 (*I have one older sister and two younger brothers.*)
3. 我沒有哥哥，也沒有弟弟。 (*I don't have an older brother, and I don't have a younger brother either.*)
4. 我只有一個姊姊。 (*I only have one older sister.*)

◆ Suggested Teaching Flow

1. The teacher takes on the roles of Wang Mingwen and Gloria Lee in turn (character portraits and family pictures may be used) to produce some of the lesson's sentences. For example: “我是王明文。我有一個姊姊，兩個弟弟。” (*I am Wang Mingwen. I have one older sister and two younger brothers.*) This exposes students to the lesson's key sentences.
2. Lead the class in reading the text aloud; students repeat together. Prepare picture cards to help students understand the text.
3. **Introduce grammar:** Divide the dialogue into sections based on grammar points and teach each part in sequence. First help students understand the meaning and roughly memorize the pronunciation, then reinforce individual grammar structures and vocabulary. For example:

(1) Use the situational context to introduce the dialogue:

- A: 明文，你有兄弟姐妹嗎? (*Mingwen, do you have siblings?*)
- B: 我有一個姐姐，兩個弟弟。 (*I have one older sister and two younger brothers.*)

(2) Teacher-student Q&A to help students get familiar with the sentences, memorize meaning, and pronounce accurately.

(3) Introduce Grammar Pattern 1 — 有 / 沒有 — and the vocabulary “兄弟姐妹 (siblings), 哥哥 (older brother), 姐姐 (older sister), 弟弟 (younger brother), 妹妹 (younger sister).” Use question-and-answer substitution drills to help students confirm the grammar structure and pay attention to pronunciation.

(4) Comprehensively review grammar structures, Chinese characters, and pronunciation with students.

(5) Then introduce the following dialogue in sequence, along with Grammar Pattern 2 — 嗎 — Grammar Pattern 3 — 個 — and other content.

4. After leading the class through the text again, ask comprehension questions based on the text.

Sample questions:

- 1. 明文有兄弟姐妹嗎? (*Does Mingwen have siblings?*)
- 2. 明文有哥哥、妹妹嗎? (*Does Mingwen have an older brother or younger sister?*)
- 3. Gloria 有兄弟姐妹嗎? (*Does Gloria have siblings?*)
- 4. 明文有姐姐，Gloria 呢? (*Mingwen has an older sister — what about Gloria?*)
- 5. Gloria 有哥哥、弟弟嗎? (*Does Gloria have an older or younger brother?*)

Then ask students to answer based on their own situations:

- 6. 我有哥哥 / 姐姐 / 弟弟 / 妹妹，你呢? (*I have an older brother / older sister / younger brother / younger sister — what about you?*)
5. Have students practice reading the text in groups, then have individual students take turns reading aloud; correct pronunciation as needed.
 6. Use the content (facts) from the text to have students practice narration using what they have learned, in order to achieve the lesson’s learning objectives. Students should be able to develop not only dialogue but also monologue-style narration.

(1) Have students work in pairs to use this lesson’s key sentences to cooperatively introduce Wang Mingwen’s and Gloria’s siblings.

(2) The teacher uses word cards or a PPT to provide the necessary vocabulary or phrases and has students produce the following content:

- a. 王明文有一個姊姊，兩個弟弟。 (*Wang Mingwen has one older sister and two younger brothers.*)
- b. Gloria 沒有哥哥，也沒有弟弟。 (*Gloria doesn’t have an older brother and doesn’t have a younger brother either.*)
- c. Gloria 只有一個姊姊。 (*Gloria only has one older sister.*)

(The above content may be adjusted flexibly by the teacher based on students’ level and circumstances.)

7. After finishing text instruction, guide students through the grammar exercises to confirm grammar structures.
8. After completing the grammar exercises, explain or demonstrate the stroke order for Chinese characters that have complex structures or that students are likely to make mistakes on.

V. Integrated Activities

1. Integrated Activity 1 — Read Aloud / Sight-Read

(1) Objective: Students can recognize the sentences in the dialogue without the aid of phonetic notation or romanization, and pronounce them correctly.

(2) Method: - a. Have students practice the dialogue in groups. - b. The teacher calls on students to take turns reading the dialogue aloud.

2. Integrated Activity 2 — Fill in the Blanks / Writing

(1) Objective: After repeating and memorizing the sentences learned in this lesson, students understand the dialogue content and can write the missing parts using Chinese characters or phonetic notation.

(2) Method: - a. Have students fill in the dialogue content. - b. The teacher calls on students to read aloud or write out the answers. - c. Writing characters or phonetic notation may be arranged based on students' level. - d. If time allows, a supplementary activity may be arranged. For students who learn quickly and are at a higher level, the supplementary activity may replace the original activity. The procedure is the same.

Supplementary Activity (*Students add or reduce sentences based on their own situation*)

A: _____, 你有_____嗎? (_____, do you have _____?)

B: 我有_____個_____, _____個_____. 你呢? (*I have [number] [sibling] and [number] [sibling]. What about you?*)

A: 我_____. (*I _____.*)

B: 你有_____嗎? (*Do you have _____?*)

A: 我_____, 也_____, 我_____有_____. (*I _____, and also _____, I _____ have _____.*)

3. Integrated Activity 3 — Speaking

(1) Objective: Students can fluently use the sentences learned in this lesson to describe and ask whether themselves and others have siblings and how many.

(2) Method: - a. Explain the activity procedure and remind students of the sentences they need to use. - b. After students complete their interviews, have them fill out a form and introduce the student they interviewed to the whole class. - c. Depending on the situation, call on students to complete the dialogue in front of the whole class. The dialogue content can refer to the Supplementary Activity from Integrated Activity 2.

VI. Supplementary Text Instruction

As circumstances allow, the teacher may use the following material as a supplementary reading or listening exercise. The teacher may read the short passage aloud to train students' listening, or make it into a handout for reading practice.

Please answer the questions below based on the passage:

Steve 有兩個哥哥，一個妹妹。王明美也有一個妹妹。王明美沒有姊姊，也沒有哥哥。明美只有一個妹妹。

(Steve has two older brothers and one younger sister. Wang Mingmei also has one younger sister. Mingmei doesn't have an older sister and doesn't have an older brother. Mingmei only has one younger sister.)

Questions: 1. Steve 有沒有哥哥? (Does Steve have an older brother?)
2. Steve 有沒有妹妹? (Does Steve have a younger sister?) 3. 明美有妹妹嗎? (Does Mingmei have a younger sister?) 4. 明美有沒有哥哥、姊姊? (Does Mingmei have an older brother or older sister?)

Answer Key: 1. Steve 有兩個哥哥。(Steve has two older brothers.) 2. Steve 有一個妹妹。(Steve has one younger sister.) 3. 明美也有一個妹妹。(Mingmei also has one younger sister.) 4. 明美沒有哥哥，也沒有姊姊。(Mingmei doesn't have an older brother and doesn't have an older sister either.)

VII. Phonetics Instruction / Phonetics Review

1. How to mark tone symbols:

- 1. When marking tone symbols, if the final vowel is "i," remove the dot above the "i" before adding the tone mark. For example: dì (弟, younger brother).
- 2. Tone marks are placed above the main vowel. The order of priority for main vowels is: a o e i u ü. For example: mèi (妹, younger sister), hǎo (好, good).

2. This lesson introduces the following phonetics:

- Initials: d, t, n, l
 - Finals: ao, ei
3. For phonetic combinations that do not exist in this lesson, try to find examples from vocabulary in other lessons for practice, using as few non-existent Mandarin sound combinations as possible. To practice all four tones of a syllable, some non-existent syllables may appear; the book marks these with parentheses — e.g., (nū), (lǔ), (mēi) — to indicate these syllables do not exist as pronunciations in Mandarin.
4. Use slides or word cards to have students read sentences or words aloud, correcting pronunciation as needed.
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參. Answer Key for In-Book Exercises

◆ Grammar Exercise Answers

1. 有 / 沒 - (1) 132 (2) 213 (3) 4132 (4) 12435 / 15432 / 32415 / 35412 (5) 21435
2. 嗎 - (1) 2341 (2) 3412 (3) 3421 (4) 1243 (5) 2431
3. 個 - (1) 123 (2) 2314 (3) 1423 (4) 31524
4. 也 - (1) 3412 (2) 15423 (3) 2413 (4) 2143
-

◆ Integrated Activity Answers

1. Read Aloud — (omitted)

2. Fill in the Blanks

兄弟姐妹 / 個 / 個 / 也有 / 沒有 / 也 / 只

(siblings / [measure word] / [measure word] / also have / don't have / also / only)

3. Speaking — (omitted)

◆ Phonetics Exercise Answers

1. Tone Discrimination - (1) (omitted) - (2) dì (弟 younger brother) / mí (迷 fascinated) / hǎo (好 good) / féi (肥 fat) / dào (到 arrive) / bāo (包 bag) / táo (逃 escape) - (3) mǐ (米 rice) / tú (圖 picture) / lǜ (綠 green) / dǎ (打 hit) / láo (勞 labor) / nèi (內 inside) / tāo (掏 dig out)

2. Word Discrimination - (1) lǐ (李 plum/surname) / ní (泥 mud) / nǚ (女 female) / tǎ (塔 tower) / pǔ (普 universal) / pà (怕 afraid) / tì (替 substitute) - (2) lào (烙 brand) / ne (呢 particle) / máo (毛 hair/fur) / běi (北 north) / nǐ (你 you) / lǘ (驢 donkey) / mèi (妹 younger sister)

肆. Workbook Answer Key

I. Text Comprehension

1. ✕ 2. ✕ 3. ✕ 4. ○

II. Tone Discrimination

1. jiě / yǒu / gē / nǐ / mèi
2. jiě / dì / yǒu / zhǐ / liǎng

III. Word Discrimination

1. 1. 弟 (2) 姊 (3) 你 (4) 只 (5) 也
2. 1. 兩個 (2) 兄弟 (3) 沒有 (4) 姊姊 (5) 哥哥
3. 也 / 兩個 / 妹妹 / 兄弟 / 有

IV. Sentence Restructuring

1. cab 2. badc 3. bcad 4. bdca 5. eadcbf

V. Matching

1. b 2. c 3. a 4. d

VI. Translation

1. 你有兄弟姐妹嗎? (*Do you have siblings?*)
2. 我有一個姐姐，兩個弟弟。你呢? (*I have one older sister and two younger brothers. What about you?*)
3. 我也有一個姐姐。 (*I also have one older sister.*)
4. 你有哥哥嗎? (*Do you have an older brother?*)
5. 我沒有哥哥，也沒有弟弟。我只有一個姐姐。 (*I don't have an older brother, and I don't have a younger brother either. I only have one older sister.*)

伍. Test Answer Key

I. Listening

1. jiějie (姐姐 older sister) 2. mèimei (妹妹 younger sister) 3. méi yǒu (沒有 don't have)
2. nǐ hǎo (你好 hello) 5. yě yǒu (也有 also have)

II. Restructuring

1. bdac 2. badc 3. cbda 4. edacb 5. cdab

III. Matching

1. d 2. c 3. b 4. a

IV. Dictation

1. 兄弟姐妹 (siblings) 2. 一個 (one [measure word]) 3. 兩個哥哥 (two older brothers) 4. 也是 (also is) 5. 只有 (only have)
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陸. Supplementary Online Resources

1. Ministry of Education Standard Script Stroke Order Learning Website

<http://stroke-order.learningweb.moe.edu.tw/home.do>

(1) Stroke Order: Characters in this lesson such as “弟 (younger brother), 嗎 (question particle), 沒 (not/haven't)” are prone to stroke order errors among students beginning to learn Chinese characters. The teacher may demonstrate the stroke order in class.

(2) Structure: Write the following characters on the board (or project them) and have students discuss together to find characters that share the same radical. This activity may be expanded based on students' level and available time. The teacher should minimize explanation and let students discuss on their own, finding answers visually.

Which of the following characters share the same radical?
好 個 嗎 姓 沒 妳 請 姐 呢 妹

(Example: 好 contains the radical 女)

Answer: 姓、妳、姐、妹 (all contain the 女 “female” radical)

2. Chinese Character Story Short Videos

Suitable for beginners. No audio narration — includes character evolution, stroke order, and pronunciation.

- 1. 「女」 (female/woman): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6DxL8upz7Ug>
 - 2. 「有」 (have): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CYPCTEXYPfw>
 - 3. 「好」 (good): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j7d7KMvX2Ic>
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3. Finger Family Song (手指家庭)

The video has no subtitles, but uses simplified characters. The sentences are simple and the melody is light and lively. The teacher may play only the audio in class, or modify the lyrics and lead the class in singing.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4TA2iKi_kPY

Lesson 2 Quiz

Name: _____

I. Listening: Circle the one that you hear.

① jiějie	② měiměi	③ méi yǒu	④ nǐ hào	⑤ yě yǒu
jiěji	mèimei	mèi yóu	nǐ hǎo	yè yóu

II. Rearrange the following words into sentences.

1. 美國人 他 嗎 是 a b c d → _____ ?

2. 有 妳 嗎 姊姊 a b c d → _____ ?

3. 弟弟 也 我 有 a b c d → _____。

4. 有 姊姊 兩個 只 他 a b c d e → _____。

5. 有 妹妹 他 沒 a b c d → _____。

III. Match the expression in A with the response in B.

A: 1. 你有姊姊嗎? (Do you have an older sister?) 2. 我沒有兄弟姊妹, 你呢? (I don't have any siblings. What about you?) 3. 我有一個弟弟, 你呢? (I have one younger brother. What about you?) 4. 我有一個姊姊, 他呢? (I have one older sister. What about him?)

B: - a. 他也有一個姊姊。 (He also has one older sister.) - b. 我沒有弟弟, 我只有一個妹妹。 (I don't have a younger brother; I only have one younger sister.) - c. 我也沒有兄弟姐妹。 (I don't have any siblings either.) - d. 我沒有姊姊。 (I don't have an older sister.)

Answers: 1-d 2-c 3-b 4-a

IV. Dictation: Write down the characters or pinyin with tone marks.

1. _____ 4. _____

2. _____ 5. _____

3. _____